

RIVERDALE HIGH SCHOOL

PARENT/STUDENT HANDBOOK 2026-2027



RIVERDALE JOINT UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

RIVERDALE HIGH SCHOOL PARENT-STUDENT HANDBOOK 2026-27

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RIVERDALE HIGH SCHOOL
PARENT-STUDENT HANDBOOK
2026-27**

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RIVERDALE UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

MISSION STATEMENT

Adopted, February 15, 1995

Students of the District shall be competent in the subjects offered by the District and shall have a positive attitude toward self and others. The curriculum offered shall reflect the subjects and activities approved by the District Governing Board and shall reflect the California State adopted curriculum.

The District Governing Board established the following goals: 1) 80% of the District's students shall score at grade level in all courses and classes; 2) To build self-worth and self-esteem, one hundred percent of the students shall be involved in at least one meaningful extra or co-curricular activity annually; 3) Graduation shall be based on students meeting minimum requirements including proof of application to a college or vocational school, proof of employment or proof of at least three job interviews with a legitimate company.

Riverdale Unified School District

Public Information

Non-Discrimination District Statement

The Governing Board is committed to providing equal opportunity for all individuals in education. District programs, activities, and practices shall be free from unlawful discrimination, including discrimination against an individual or group based on race, color, ancestry, nationality, national origin, ethnic group identification, age, religion, marital, pregnancy, or parental status, physical or mental disability, sex, sexual orientation, gender, immigration status, gender identity or expression, or genetic information; a perception of one or more of such characteristics; or association with a person or group with one or more of these actual or perceived characteristics. (Ed. Code §§ 234.7)

Special Education Records

Riverdale Joint Unified School District maintains Special Education records for students until they reach age 25. Special Education records of students with a year of birth on or before 2001 including Individualized Education Plans (IEPs), will be destroyed at the end of the 2026 calendar year. If you wish to obtain a copy of your records, you may contact Carina Rodriguez at [559-867-8200](tel:559-867-8200) prior to December 31, 2026.

School Accountability Report Card (SARC)

The School Accountability Report Card (SARC) is a comprehensive annual report that provides parents and the community with important information about a school's performance, including student achievement data, teacher qualifications, school safety measures, and available curriculum. Mandated by California law, it serves as a tool for transparency, allowing families to evaluate a school's progress and educational environment. While the latest reports are available online for digital viewing, a hard copy of the SARC is also available for parents to pick up at their child's school front office.

ACADEMIC STANDARDS AND POLICIES

GRADUATION REQUIREMENTS

1. Students must successfully meet the District's minimum proficiency standards.
2. Students must successfully complete 250 semester credits in grades 9-12.
3. All students, unless otherwise noted, must successfully complete the following Riverdale High School courses:
 - (a) **Social Science** : Three one-year courses
 - (b) **English** : Four one-year courses;
 - (c) **Mathematics** : Three one-year courses;
 - (d) **Science** : Three one-year courses
Biology, Chemistry and Physics
 - (e) **Physical Education** : Two one-year courses;
 - (f) **Fine Arts** : One year course in, Art Appreciation, World Language, Music, or Drama;
 - (g) **Ethnic Studies** : One semester course in Ethnic Studies beginning with the freshman class of 2025-2026 (Class of 2029)
 - (h) **Freshman Requirement** : One year of Freshman Studies (Ending at the conclusion of 2027-2028 school year), Freshman Literacy or AVID 9
 - (i) **Personal Finance** : One semester course in Personal Finance beginning with the freshman class of 2027-2028 (Class of 2031)
4. Graduating seniors must show documented evidence of application to a college or vocational school, proof of employment, evidence of 3 interviews for employment, or military enlistment.

CREDITS NEEDED TO ADVANCE TO THE NEXT GRADE LEVEL

10th Grade/Sophomore Status.....	Passed 60 Credits
11th Grade/Junior Status.....	Passed 120 Credits
12th Grade/Senior Status	Passed 180 Credits

CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETION REQUIREMENTS

An individual with exceptional needs may be awarded a certificate of completion. (Education Code 56390)

To obtain a certificate of completion, students may complete 250 credits including the following alternative course of study in grades 9-12, with each course being one year unless otherwise specified:

1. Four courses in English
2. Three courses in mathematics
3. Three courses in science
4. Three courses in social studies
5. Two courses in physical education
6. One freshman requirement course ending at the conclusion of the 2027-28 school year.

7. One semester in Ethnic Studies beginning with the 2028-29 school year.
8. One technology course ending at the conclusion of the 2024-25 school year
9. One semester in Personal Finance beginning with the 2030-31 school year
10. Additional elective coursework

DELAYED ENROLLMENT

Any continuing student who wishes to delay fall or spring enrollment without prior notification will be re-enrolled upon return. Students must understand that they may not be able to re-register for their same classes due to the limited availability.

STUDENT ADVISEMENT

Student Advisement: "All students at Riverdale High School will meet with the College and Career Counselor or their assigned Assistant Principal and their parent, as needed, to discuss academics, career decisions/choices, graduation requirements, college choices/entrance, scholarship applications, attendance and discipline. The College and Career Counselor is available to offer students information/guidance on post-secondary opportunities as well as grant and scholarship opportunities.

GRADES AND REPORT CARDS

Progress reports and final semester grades will be issued to students enrolled for more than 50% of the quarter, evaluating student achievement and proficiency in the academic subject areas. Student effort and citizenship may also be evaluated.

Official grades are based on the final semester grade. Progress reports will be mailed at the end of each quarter grading period as well as at each progress reporting period. This report will give the grade as it is accumulated to that point. Eligibility for extra -curricular activities (including dances) will be based on the quarter grade reports. Students will be declared ineligible if they are below a 2.0 G.P.A. and/or have one or more failing grades.

Students may petition for eligibility during one quarter each school year.

VALEDICTORIAN/SALUTATORIAN/HONOR CUP REQUIREMENTS

G.P.A. is computed on grades earned from 9th through 12th grades, excluding Aide and Tutor course, , and grades earned from schools that are not accredited. This G.P.A. calculation is used to determine Valedictorian, Salutatorian, and students receiving Honor Cups. Honor Cups are determined by students who have taken, or in progress of, 180 credits (equivalent to 36 – 5 credit courses) with a high "B" (3.5 GPA) or better [Low "A" (3.75 GPA) or better beginning with the Class of 2029] from College Prep courses including Honors and AP courses by the end of the 3rd quarter of their senior year. Seniors who graduate with a .3.5 – 3.99 weighted grade point average will earn "Honors" and those with a 4.0 and above will earn "High Honors" designation at graduation.

GRADE POINTS EARNED

REGULAR COURSES

A	=	4.00
B	=	3.00
C	=	2.00
D	=	1.00
F	=	0.00

HONORS/AP COURSES

A	=	5.00
B	=	4.00
C	=	3.00
D	=	1.00
F	=	0.00

AWARDS/ACADEMIC LETTER CRITERIA

Students accumulating a G.P.A. of 3.75 and above are eligible to receive an academic letter at the end of each year. Students earning a 3.5 GPA at the end of each quarter will earn Honor Roll recognition.

Golden State Seal of Merit Diploma

The Golden State Seal Merit Diploma (GSSMD) insignia is awarded jointly by the State Board of Education and the State Superintendent of Public Instruction to recognize students who have demonstrated mastery of the high school curriculum in at least six subject areas. In order for students to qualify for this seal to be placed on their diploma, as per requirements set forth by the California Department of Education, they must have demonstrated mastery of the curriculum within at least six subject areas: English Language Arts, Mathematics, Science, United States History, and two additional subject areas. For more information on qualifying for this please see your academic counselor.

California State Seal of Biliteracy

The state seal of Biliteracy was established to recognize high school graduates who have attained a high level of proficiency in speaking, reading, and writing in one or more languages in addition to English. Students must demonstrate completion of all English language arts requirements for graduation with an overall GPA of 2.0 in these classes, passage of the CAASPP English language arts exam at or above the "standard met" achievement level, proficiency in one or more languages as demonstrated through; passage of a world language advanced placement (AP) examination with a score of 3 or higher, completion of a 4 year high school course of study in a world language with an overall GPA of 3.0 or higher in that course, passage of the SAT II world language examination. For more information on qualifying for this please see your academic counselor.

TESTING AND CAREER CHOICE ASSISTANCE

While enrolled at Riverdale High School, students are required to take various tests for a variety of reasons. All of these tests give both the student and assistant principal a better idea of the students' interests, aptitudes and abilities. A college and career counselor will also be available to assist students in the development of personal learning plans.

EAP: The California State University (CSU) participates in the Early Assessment Program (EAP), an academic preparation program to help high school students meet college-readiness standards in English language arts and mathematics before admission to a CSU campus. This test is given to 11th grade students in the spring of their junior year as part of the Smarter Balanced Assessments.

SMARTER BALANCED ASSESSMENTS: The Smarter Balanced Assessment Consortium is developing a system of valid, reliable, and fair next-generation assessments aligned to the *Common Core State Standards (CCSS)* in English language arts/literacy (ELA/literacy) and mathematics for grades 3-8 and 11. 11th grade students take these exams in the spring of their junior year.

SAT/ACT: Seniors going to a four-year college may take the ACT or SAT (Scholastic Aptitude Test). The PSAT test is for sophomores and juniors to prepare them for the SAT. It is suggested juniors take the SAT in the spring of their junior year. Seniors planning to apply to a four-year college **are encouraged to** take the ACT or SAT. Seniors should check application requirements for four-year colleges they plan to apply to.

ELPAC: All students identified as English Learners (EL) are assessed to determine their level of English proficiency.

FOUR-YEAR PLANNING GUIDE

Educational Goals	Grade 9	Grade 10	Grade 11	Grade 12
High School Diploma	English 9 P Biology P/Ag Bio P Integrated Math 9P Ethnic Studies P/Freshman Studies Freshman P.E. VP Arts Req or World Lang. Req	English 10 P Chemistry P/ Ag Soil Chemistry P World History P Integrated Math 10P/H Sophomore P.E. Elective VP Arts Req or World Lang. Req	English 11 P Physics Integrated Math 11P U.S. History P VP Arts Req or Elective Elective Elective	CSU Expository English Civics/Economics P Applied Math P or Elective Elective Elective Elective
Community College A.A. Degree C.S.U., U.C. or Private College or University B.A./B.S. Degree	English 9Por 9H Biology Por Agriculture Biology P Integrated Math 9Por 9H Ethnic Studies P/Freshman Studies Freshman P.E. or Business Req or VP Arts or World Language Elective	English 10Por 10H Chemistry P / Ag Soil Chemistry P Integrated Math 10Por 10H World History P/AP Sophomore P.E. or VP Arts Req or Spanish I/II P	English 11P/AP Physics P Integrated Math 11P or 11H U.S. History P/AP Physics Spanish IIP/IIIP/AP Elective Elective	CSU Expos English or/AP Civics/Econ P or AP/H Intro to Stats/ College Level Math Prep Spanish III P or AP Anatomy/Physiology or AP Biology Elective

COLLEGE SUBJECT REQUIREMENTS:

*All courses from “a-g” list

Minimum grade of “C” earned in all “a-g” college prep courses.

CSU: 11 of the 15 “a-g” (college prep) courses must be completed by end of junior year.

UC: Minimum weighted GPA in “a-g” (college prep) classes from 10th and 11 grade: 3.0

“a-g” Subject Categories	CSU/UC	CSU/UC Recommends
a: Social Science (US, World History & Civics)	2 years	
b: English	4 years	
c: Math (IM 9, IM 10, Integrated Math 11P/11H)	3 years	4 years: CLMP/AP Calc AB
d: Lab Science (Biology & Chemistry)	2 years	3 years: Physics
e: World Language	2 years	3 years: Span. III, AP Lit. or AP Lang
f: Visual & Performing Art (Theatre Arts II – IV, Band, Art, Choir)	1 year	
g: College Prep Elective	1 year	

ATTENDANCE REGULATIONS AND REQUIREMENTS

ATTENDANCE POLICY

The state laws of California require the school attendance of every person under the age of eighteen. In addition, the administration of Riverdale High School believes it is essential for students to attend school on a regular basis to be successful in their educational experience. When a student must be absent from school, only the following reasons will be acceptable to classify as "excused."

1. Illness
2. Doctor or dentist appointment
3. Death in the immediate family
4. Observance of a religious holiday
5. Quarantine
6. Visit with an immediate family member who is an active duty service member on leave, on deployment or returned from deployment.
7. Absences or tardiness due to unsafe weather or fog conditions (when a parent/guardian is unable to transport their student safely) are excused upon parent/guardian notification to the school.

An absence is classified as "unexcused" when a student is absent for any part of the school day for reasons other than those listed above. School work missed due to an unexcused absence may not be made up. An exception will be made in regard to the school work if the parent notifies the school prior to the absence.

Students who are repeatedly truant may be considered for referral to an alternate educational placement.

The parent or guardian of a student who is absent should phone the school at (559) 867-3562 between 7:30 a.m. and 12:00 noon and give the following information:

1. Parent or guardian's name
2. Student's name
3. Reason for absence
4. Estimated date of return
5. Whether assignments are needed

If the parent or guardian has not notified the school concerning the absence, the student must bring a note from the parent explaining the reason for the absence and obtain an admit slip from the main office upon return. A parent must verify a student's absence within two days, otherwise the absence will be classified as **unexcused** until it is cleared in the main office. The main office will open at 7:30 a.m..

SATURDAY SCHOOL

Saturday School is mandated for each absence exceeding ten in a course and/or three or more truancy absences in a course. Saturday school may also be used as an alternative consequence for disciplinary actions.

TARDY/CUTS PROCEDURES

If a student is not in class when the bell rings, the student is tardy.

There is a 4-minute pass time between classes. At four (4) minutes, a tardy bell will sound to designate the start of class.

Five (5) or more minutes late to class after the bell rings is considered a **cut**. A class cut will result in a loss of 5 citizenship points and the assignment of a lunch detention.

Upon receiving a total of 4 tardies in any combination of classes, a student will receive a warning notice through a discipline mailing. Upon receiving 8 tardies, 5 citizenship points will be deducted and a lunch detention will be assigned. With each additional series of 4 tardies (12, 16, 20, etc.), a student will be deducted 5 citizenship points and will be assigned 1 day of After School Detention (3:20-6:15). Habitual tardiness may be cause for a parent meeting, the placement of a student on a reassessment contract, or consideration for placement at an alternative school site.

TARDY SWEEPS

1. Tardy Sweeps will be conducted at random by school administration.
2. Students caught in a Tardy Sweep will be sent to class once they have obtained a **pass** from an administrator and will be assigned a mandatory lunch detention on that day or the following day.

ADMITTANCE OF STUDENTS TO CLASS

1. Students who reach school after 8:10 a.m. must report to the main office for a **late slip**.
2. Students who are late to class because they were held over by another teacher or summoned to the office must have a hall pass.

STUDENTS WHO DO NOT HAVE THE APPROPRIATE PASS/SLIP WILL NOT BE ADMITTED TO CLASS

RIVERDALE HIGH SCHOOL ATTENDANCE REQUIREMENTS

10 Absences (Per Semester for Each Course for Course Credit)	Saturday school will be mandated for each absence exceeding <u>10 in a course per semester</u>. Attending one Saturday school will replace one absence in each class. Students who complete the semester with more than 10 absences in a class will lose credits for that class. (BP 5121 - Students exceeding 10 absences in a course are subject to losing credit for that course even if a passing grade is earned).
Absences are Notes From Parents/Guardians	- cutting class, suspensions, staying home because you do not feel well, doctors and dentists appointments, or just not coming to school. If the student misses school for ANY reason, that absence (excused or not) will be counted against the student. This DOES INCLUDE staying home with a headache, etc. even though your parent sends a note or calls the school stating you were ill. It DOES NOT INCLUDE school sponsored trips. - regarding students who are ill: students need a note stating the reason they are absent, and it must be signed by their parent/guardian.
Special Circumstances For Petition Include	a hospital stay, etc. or other special circumstances must be submitted to the principal for review. The parent or guardian must submit the proper paperwork to the principal in order to receive approval. Petitions will be accepted only for death in the immediate family, observance of a religious holiday, hospitalization and quarantine. A note from the doctor will be required for quarantine. Please see the school secretary/attendance clerk for the required paperwork to clear an absence. Within two weeks of an absence, due to special circumstances, a petition accompanied with proper documentation must be submitted to the Principal for review. Absences that are reviewed and approved through the petition process will not be counted towards the accumulated 10 absence policy to maintain credit with in a course. Please see the school secretary/attendance clerk for the required paperwork to clear the absence.
Truancy (Year Long for Each Course)	E.C. 48260(a) Any pupil subject to compulsory full-time education or to compulsory continuation education who is absent from school without valid excuse three full days in one school year or tardy or absent for more than any 30-minute period during the school day without a valid excuse on three occasions in one school year, or any combination thereof, is a truant and shall be reported to the attendance supervisor or to the superintendent of the school district. Students will also be referred to Saturday School.
Students	will need to keep an accurate record of their attendance but may request a copy of their attendance record from the school secretary/attendance clerk

At the beginning of each school year, the Superintendent or designee shall send a notification to the parents/guardians of all students, and to all students in grades 7-12 informing them that school authorities may excuse any student from school to obtain confidential medical services without the consent of the student's parent/guardian (Education Code 46010.1) Please see page 33 for a copy of the Riverdale Joint Unified School District's Truancy or Excessive Absences Guidelines" and School Attendance Review Board (SARB) Process. (Education Code 48260(a)).

EXPANDED LEARNING PROGRAM

Mission of Expanded Learning Program

The Expanded Learning Program promotes a safe and positive environment for Riverdale High School students to continue to achieve both academic and personal success through educational and enrichment opportunities. After Hours is open to all Riverdale High School students for the following:

1. Additional Support Opportunities scheduled with staff
2. Athletics
3. Cyber High Credit Recovery Program

During the school year, the Expanded Learning program is open.

Schedule

Program runs from the time school is out until 6:00 p.m. Students must sign up daily for the late bus. Late Bus departs at 6:15 p.m. from the bus parking lot.

Expanded Learning Program Rules

Students are to be responsible and must:

(1) Students must sign in to their assigned after ELP area no later than 3:25 on regular school days and by 2:10 on Early Release Mondays. Students MAY NOT LEAVE CAMPUS between the end of classes and the start time of the ELP. Once signed in, students may not leave unless given permission by ASP supervisor.

Students who fail to follow the above rules will be held accountable for the following consequences:

<u>Student Step</u>	<u>Consequence</u>
1	: Verbal warning by RHS administration, incident documented, parent contact
2	: Verbal warning by RHS administration, incident documented, parent contact
3	: Student is dropped from Expanded Learning Program and loses eligibility for the remainder of the season. Incident documented, parent contact.

DISCIPLINARY POLICIES AND CONSEQUENCES

NONPRIVILEGED LIST

Students on the Nonprivileged List may not attend any Riverdale Unified School District extracurricular activity or co-curricular activities beyond the expectations and requirements of the curriculum (includes athletic events, club/class activities, dances, etc.) on or off school grounds.

Every student begins each quarter with forty (40) citizenship points. Points are deducted for noted discipline offenses.

Students who fall below twenty-five (25) citizenship points earn one week on the Nonprivileged List in addition to other imposed consequences. Additional losses of points earn additional weeks on the Nonprivileged List as listed below:

<u>Student Falls Below</u>		<u>Consequence</u>
25 points	:	1 week on Nonprivileged List
15 points	:	1 additional week on Nonprivileged List
10 points	:	1 additional week on Nonprivileged List (and parent conference with assistant principal)
5 points	:	Student is on the Nonprivileged List until the beginning of the next quarter, which may be carried over into the next semester.
0 points	:	Student will be considered for a reassessment contract <u>or</u> an alternative educational program

*Students will not have the opportunity to earn back citizenship points during a quarter. Points are re-established at the end of each quarter throughout the school year.

RJUSD Dress Code

The purpose of these standards of dress and grooming is to promote the education of students, teaching, and a secure and safe learning environment consistent with Board policy.

All clothing shall be neat, clean, and acceptable in repair and appearance, and shall be worn within the bounds of decency and good taste as appropriate for school.

1. Pajamas shall not be worn to school.
2. Clothing shall be sufficient to conceal undergarments at all times. This may require use of a belt to support pants at the waist.
3. Articles of clothing or apparel which could be considered gang related, contain profanity or products or slogans which promote tobacco, alcohol, drugs or sex, or those which create disorder or disrupt the educational process are not allowed. Long coats (e.g. trench coats) are not permitted.
4. Tank tops, halter tops, bare midriffs or bare chests, see-through outfits, or off the shoulder blouses are not appropriate or acceptable. Straps must be at least 1 inch in width. Spaghetti straps are not permitted.
5. Skirts and shorts shall be of appropriate length and shall not distract from the educational process. At minimum, length of skirts and shorts shall be reasonably close to mid-thigh.
6. All students must wear shoes. Appropriate footwear must be worn for physical education. Closed toe shoes must be worn in shop classes.
7. Official school headwear, along with solid white, gray, black, or green hats/caps may be worn on campus. Hats, hoods, and sunglasses must be removed when indoors.

8. Hair and facial hair shall be neatly groomed. Hair that causes undue attention is not permitted. This includes unusual or extreme designs, colors, symbols, razor cuts, or messages.
9. Tattoos, permanent or temporary, must be covered at all times.

Certain rules in the dress code will be relaxed on designated activity, dress-up, or spirit days. For example, pajamas will be allowed on "Pajama Day."

PROHIBITED SPORTS APPAREL

Due to gang affiliation, the following college/professional team sports apparel will not be allowed:

Chicago Bulls	Dallas Cowboys	Georgia Bulldogs	Oakland Raiders
Chicago Cubs	Duke University	Kansas City Royals	Philadelphia Phillies
Chicago White Sox	Florida State	L.A. Dodgers	San Francisco 49ers
Cleveland Browns	Fresno State Bulldogs*	Michigan	U.N.L.V.
Colorado Rockies	Georgetown	New York Yankees	U.S.C.

*In the spirit of a college going culture, RHS students will be allowed to wear Fresno State apparel, so long as it does not contain the word Bulldogs or have the Bulldogs Logo.

Also, any apparel with a bulldog will not be allowed, whether or not it is associated with a sports team. No solid red or blue apparel will be allowed, with the exception of collared shirts.

Students who wear excessive red or blue may be given a dress code violation. This is at the determination of school administration.

The Board grants the administration the authority to modify and/or adopt more restrictive apparel and grooming policies due to repeated and/or excessive violations by a single student, group of students, or the student body.

DISCIPLINE POLICY

The intent of school and classroom rules is to provide the best possible school environment for maximum learning. These are basic discipline rules which will help give each student the right to learn and each teacher the right to teach.

CLASSROOM RULES:

1. Be on time and prepared.
2. Do not disrupt learning or teaching.
3. No food or drinks in classrooms or hallways. Gum or seeds are **not allowed on campus.**
4. Be courteous, respectful and cooperative.

GENERAL RULES:

1. Remain on campus.
2. Obey supervisor on duty.
3. Follow school and campus rules.
4. Behavior in restrooms, halls, etc. is to be appropriate.
5. Report to classroom when bell rings.

Positive behavior will be emphasized and rewarded using the RHS Cowboy C.O.D.E. Incentive Program.

Failure to display behavior expectations or violation of school rules will result in disciplinary consequences which can include, but **are** not limited to **one or more of the following**: loss of citizenship

points, detention (lunch or after school) community service, **PBIS behavior response**, loss of privileges and/or eligibility, suspension and expulsion.

Cowboy CODE

	Classroom	School Grounds / Hallways	Cafeteria/ Snack Bar	Bus / Bus Area	Restrooms
<i>C</i> Courteous	Use polite and appropriate language, Respect others' property and personal space	Report unsafe conditions, Respect others' property and personal space	Respect others' place in line, Be respectful to everyone	Use appropriate language, Respect others' property and personal space	Keep walls and surfaces clear of graffiti, Respect the privacy of others, Flush toilet & turn off water
<i>O</i> On Task	Collaborate with peers and ask for help, Be prepared and participate	Use polite and appropriate language, Clean up after yourself	Keep hands and feet to yourself	Stay seated with seatbelt on, while the bus is in motion	Use restroom for it's intended purpose, Report unsafe conditions
<i>D</i> Determined	Be in the classroom before the tardy bell rings	Walk at all times, Stay in supervised areas, Maintain appropriate space with a significant other	Clean up after yourself	Wait for the bus to stop before approaching and exiting	Leave equipment in working condition, Clean up after yourself, throw away trash and wash your hands
<i>E</i> Excellence	Bring a positive attitude, Follow the Riverdale Unified technology policy	Have a pass during class time, Manage your time	Use appropriate language & manners, Manage your time	Wait your turn in line	Use restroom on your own time

DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURES FOR SPECIFIC OFFENSES

The Mission Statement of Riverdale Unified School District focuses on student learning and achievement. All staff members are assigned the duty of assisting and supporting students. The success of our students can only be accomplished in an environment that is safe and orderly and one that will not tolerate any disruption of the educational process.

The District rules/regulations and procedures governing suspension and expulsion are on file at the District Office for your inspection.

The District employs a detection canine program that identifies the possible presence of drugs or weapons. The canine program is applied to classrooms, parking lots, other facilities and student belongings only.

The specific consequences listed in this section are minimum consequences only. Consequences may be extended at the discretion of the administrator after considering the severity of the offense.

All school suspensions may either be on-campus suspensions, or removal from school, as deemed appropriate.

Factors such as the seriousness of the offense, the circumstances under which it occurred, and the student's past record will be considered in deciding what disciplinary action will be taken. The administration of Riverdale High School reserves the right to decide what course of action will be applied.

The following rules have been designed to provide students with a safe and orderly environment.

1. WEAPONS, FIRECRACKERS, AND/OR EXPLOSIVES

The possession of a firearm, knife, explosive or other dangerous object of no reasonable use to the pupil at school or at a school related function is prohibited. All cases will be reported to the proper law enforcement agencies.

Any Offense - Loss of ten (10) to thirty (30) citizenship points, suspension and recommendation to the Superintendent for expulsion.

2. ARSON, ASSAULT & BATTERY, POSSESSION OF ALCOHOL, DRUGS, AND/OR DRUG PARAPHERNALIA, HARASSMENT OF ANY FORM, SEXUAL ASSAULT-BATTERY, ROBBERY & EXTORTION OR THREATS ON SCHOOL PERSONNEL OR STUDENTS

In all cases of arson, robbery, or extortion, restitution will be made by student or legal guardian for losses or damages to school buildings, school property, or possessions of students, staff members, and visitors. All arson cases will be reported to the proper law enforcement agencies.

Any of the above occurring at any time or place related to school functions will be reported to the proper law enforcement agencies.

Any Offense - Loss of ten (10) to thirty (30) citizenship points, suspension and possible referral to an alternative educational program or recommendation to the Superintendent for expulsion.

3. AMMUNITION

The possession of ammunition at school or at a school related function is strictly prohibited. Possession of ammunition at school may be reported to law enforcement.

Any Offense - Loss of ten (10) to thirty (30) citizenship points, and/or possible one (1) to five (5) day suspension. More serious or repeated violations could lead to placement in an alternative education program or recommendation for expulsion.

4. VANDALISM OR LOCKER MISUSE

In all cases of vandalism, restitution will be made by student or legal guardian for losses or damages to school buildings, school property, or possessions of students, staff members and visitors.

Lockers are the property of the Riverdale Joint Unified School District and are provided as a convenience for students. Students should not share lockers or give their combinations to other students because of possible theft and/or vandalism. Students are responsible for the contents of their lockers including personal property and items belonging to the school district. Lockers can be searched by school personnel at any time with just cause. Students will pay for the replacement and/or repairs as a result of intentional misuse.

Any Offense - (Depending upon severity) Loss of five (5) to thirty (30) citizenship points, one (1) to five (5) days suspension, and possible reporting to the proper law enforcement agencies with recommendation to the Superintendent for expulsion.

5. BULLYING, HAZING, FIGHTING, FORGERY, OR THEFT

Bullying is generally defined as an intentional act that causes harm to others, and may involve verbal harassment, verbal or non-verbal threats, physical assault, stalking, or other methods of coercion such as manipulation, blackmail, or extortion. It is aggressive behavior that intends to hurt, threaten or frighten another person.

Hazing is bullying or forcing someone to do unnecessary or ridiculous tasks. "Birthday Bashing" will be dealt with as would any other form of hazing and/or bullying.

In all cases of theft, restitution will be made by the student or legal guardian for losses; or item(s) will be returned in the condition in which it was taken.

Any Offense - Loss of ten (10) to thirty (30) citizenship points and/or possible one (1) to five (5) day suspension. More serious or repeated violations could lead to placement in an alternative educational program or recommendation for expulsion.

6. BUS CONDUCT

Bus transportation is an extension of the school site. Disciplinary action for inappropriate behavior may be taken by the bus driver through the transportation department. Misconduct will result in the issuance of a bus citation to the student. (See Standards of Conduct for School Bus Transportation - p. 28-29)

First Citation - Warning and parent notification.

Second Citation - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points, parent notification and loss of bus privileges for a minimum of one (1) day.

Third Citation - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points, parent notification, one (1) day detention and loss of bus privileges for a minimum of three (3) days

Fourth Citation - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points, parent notification, one (1) day detention, and loss of bus privileges for a minimum of ten (10) days.

Fifth Citation - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points, one (1) day detention, and loss of bus privileges pending a parent conference with Southwest Transportation Agency and an administrator.

7. TOBACCO (Smoking or Chewing) & E-CIGARETTES

The possession or use of tobacco on a school campus or at any school-sponsored event is prohibited.

First Offense - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points and one (1) day detention or one (1) day suspension.

Repeat Offenses - Loss of twenty (20) citizenship points and two (2) days detention or two (2) days suspension.

8. PORNOGRAPHY

Possession or distribution of pornographic literature or materials, both published and **electronic** on campus or at a school activity is prohibited.

First Offense - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points and one (1) day detention or one (1) day suspension.

Second Offense - Loss of twenty (20) citizenship points and three (3) days suspension and possible referral to an alternative educational program.

9. ELECTRONIC DEVICES, INCLUDING CELL PHONES

The use of cell phones or other electronic devices, are not allowed to be used on campus at any time that class is in session (8:10 – 3:15), unless permission has been given by school administration. The usage of electronic devices is strictly prohibited when class is in session unless an instructor has given permission for the use of such a device for academic purposes. Students must power off devices and keep them out of sight during class time.

Cell phones and other electronic devices, may be used on campus before and after school and during breaks and lunch. However, the use of such devices is subject to regulation by the school. Students who violate this policy or other District rules while using such devices are subject to disciplinary action. Students may use the office phone for urgent needs during class time with permission from a staff member.

Students are NOT allowed to take pictures of individuals without their consent. Smartphones and other mobile communication devices shall not be used in any manner which infringes on the privacy rights of any other person. This includes live calls, live streaming, audio recording, and video recording without the consent of all parties.

First Offense – The item will be confiscated and turned in to the office. The student will receive a loss of ten (10) citizenship points. Only a parent or guardian will be allowed to retrieve the device from administration.

Second Offense – The item will be confiscated and turned in to the office. The student will receive a one (1) day suspension and a loss of ten (10) citizenship points. Only a parent or guardian will be allowed to retrieve the device from administration.

Third Offense – The item will be confiscated and turned in to the office. The student will receive a three (3) day suspension and a loss of ten (10) citizenship points. Only a parent or guardian will be allowed to retrieve the device from administration.

No student shall be prohibited from possessing or using an electronic device that is determined by a licensed physician or surgeon to be essential for the student's health and the use of which is limited to health-related purposes. (Education Code 48902.5)

The District is not responsible for lost or stolen personal electronic devices and/or cellular/digital telephones.

10. INTERNET SAFETY POLICY

Accessing inappropriate internet sites will result in the following consequences.

First Offense – loss of ten (10) citizenship points and a loss of internet use for three (3) months.

Second Offense – Loss of twenty (20) citizenship points a loss of internet use for one (1) year.

11. DEFIANCE, DISRESPECT, INSUBORDINATION

Students who willfully defy the valid authority of school personnel and school rules or are disrespectful, either in language or action, are subject to disciplinary action.

First Offense - Loss of ten (10) to twenty (20) citizenship points and one (1) to three (3) day detention, possible referral to counselor.

Second Offense - Loss of ten (10) to twenty (20) citizenship points and possible referral to counselor.

Third Offense - Loss of twenty (20-30) citizenship points and consideration of referral to an alternative educational program.

12. GAMBLING

Gambling on school grounds, including the pitching of coins, is prohibited.

First Offense - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points and one (1) day detention or a one (1) day suspension.

Second and Repeat Offenses - Loss of twenty (20) citizenship points, three (3) to five (5) day suspension and possible referral to an alternative educational program.

13. CUTTING CLASS, LOITERING, LEAVING CAMPUS WITHOUT PERMISSION

Students are not allowed to leave campus between the opening and closing of the school day. Exceptions will be made for those students with an off-campus permit approved by an administrator.

Less than five minutes to class is considered a tardy. Five minutes or more late to class is considered a cut.

Students may not leave campus. Students are not allowed to be on another school's campus without the permission of that school's administration.

First Offense - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points for each offense or period cut (up to thirty (30) points) and one (1) day detention or one (1) day Saturday School. A full day cut will result in a loss of thirty (30) points and a one (1) day Saturday School..

Second Offense - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points for each period cut (up to thirty (30) points) and three (3) days Saturday School, or three (3) days detention.

Third Offense - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points for each period cut and suspension pending referral to an alternative educational program for repeated defiance.

14. CHEATING/PLAGIARISM

First Offense - Loss of twenty (20) citizenship points and one (1) day detention or one (1) day suspension. Student will receive an "F" grade for that assignment or test.

Second Offense - Loss of thirty (30) citizenship points and two (2) days detention or two (2) days suspension. Student will receive an "F" grade for that assignment or test. Teacher will contact parent.

Third Offense - Loss of twenty (20) citizenship points and suspension of five (5) or more days pending referral to an alternative educational program.

15. AUDITORIUM/GYMNASIUM DISRUPTION AND/OR MISBEHAVIOR

First Offense - Student will immediately be sent to the office and assigned one (1) day detention and the student will lose ten (10) citizenship points.

Second Offense - Student will immediately be sent to the office and assigned two (2) days detention and the student will lose ten (10) citizenship points. The student will not be allowed to attend an assembly/performance for the remainder of the school year.

16. PROFANITY OR VULGARITY

Use of profanity or vulgarity on campus or at a school event is prohibited.

First Offense - Loss of five (5) citizenship points.

Repeated offenses - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points and one (1) day detention or a one (1) day suspension.

17. DRESS CODE VIOLATIONS

Any student in violation of the dress code will be referred to an assistant principal. A student will not return to class or participate in a school activity until he/she is in compliance with the dress code.

First Offense - Loss of five (5) citizenship points.

Second Offense - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points and one (1) day detention

Third and Repeat Offense - Loss of twenty (20) citizenship points and one (1) day detention.

18. PARKING LOT VIOLATIONS,

Students may not go into the parking lot between the opening and closing of the school day without prior administrative approval.

First Offense - Loss of five (5) citizenship points.

Second Offense - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points and one (1) day detention.

Third and Repeat Offense - Loss of twenty (20) citizenship points and one (1) day detention.

19. PARKING PASS VIOLATION

Students parking within the student parking lot, the south side of the South Gym, must display a school issued parking pass on their rear view mirror at all times. Those vehicles observed without a parking pass within the student parking lot are subject to the following discipline:

First Offense: Warning and Parent Notification

Second and Repeat Offense: Loss of ten (10) to twenty (20) citizenship points and/or loss of parking privileges. More serious or repeated violations would lead to possible towing and impoundment at owner's expense.

20. DISPLAYS OF AFFECTION

Any inappropriate displays of affection will not be allowed on school campus or at school functions. Holding hands is acceptable.

First Offense - Meeting with the assistant principal and the loss of five (5) citizenship points.

Repeat Offenses - Loss of ten (10) citizenship points, referral for counseling and one (1) day detention.

Major Offenses – Loss of ten (10) citizenship points, referral for counseling and one – five (1-5) day suspension

21. BICYCLES AND SKATEBOARDS

Bicycles and skateboards may be ridden to and from school. It is the student's responsibility to lock/secure the bicycle. Bicycles and skateboards are not to be ridden during school time or stored in classrooms or offices at any time during the school day.

First Offense - Confiscation for the remainder of the school day and loss of five (5) citizenship points.

Repeat Offenses - Confiscation and loss of ten (10) citizenship points and one (1) day detention.

Parent or guardian of the student may come to the school to claim the bicycle or skateboard.

22. TARDIES

If a student is not in class when the bell rings, the student is tardy.

There is a 4-minute pass time between classes. At four (4) minutes, a tardy bell will sound to designate the start of class.

Five (5) or more minutes late to class after the bell rings is considered a **cut**. A class cut will result in a loss of 10 citizenship points and the assignment of a lunch detention.

Upon receiving a total of 4 tardies in any combination of classes, a student will receive a warning notice through a discipline mailing. Upon receiving 8 tardies, 10 citizenship points will be deducted and a lunch detention will be assigned. With each additional series of 4 tardies (12, 16, 20, etc.), a student will be deducted 10 citizenship points and will be assigned 1 day of After School Detention (3:20-6:15). Habitual tardiness may be cause for a parent meeting, the placement of a student on a reassessment contract, or consideration for placement at an alternative school site.

23. CYBERBULLYING

Cyber Bullying is the use of information and communication technologies to support deliberate, repeated, or hostile behavior by an individual or group, that is intended to harm others.

Otherwise stated, it is use of the Internet, e-mail, cell phones or other devices used to send, forward, display or post text or images intended to hurt, embarrass, or threaten another person.

Any Offense – Loss of ten (10) to thirty (30) citizenship points and/or possible one (1) to five (5) day suspension. More serious or repeated violations could lead to placement in an alternative educational program or recommendation for expulsion.

STUDENT SEXUAL HARASSMENT

It is the policy of Riverdale Unified School District that all of its students should be free from harassment (especially sexual harassment). As part of this policy, the District is committed to investigating claims of such harassment (especially sexual harassment) and taking appropriate disciplinary or other actions when the factors show that such harassment has occurred.

The District will not tolerate harassment (especially sexual harassment) of any kind and will take appropriate disciplinary action whenever such harassment is demonstrated. Any individual who engages in such conduct contrary to this policy may be personally liable in any legal action brought against him or her.

A. DEFINITION OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT

Sexual harassment means unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal, visual or physical conduct of a sexual nature, made by someone from or in the educational setting, under any of the following conditions:

1. Submission to such conduct is made a term or condition of the student's academic status or progress at the educational institution;
2. Submission to, or rejection of, such conduct is the basis for academic decisions affecting the student;
3. Such conduct has the purpose or effect of having a negative impact upon the student's academic performance, or has the purpose or effect of creating an intimidating, hostile, or offensive educational environment; or
4. Submission to, or rejection of, the conduct by the student is used as the basis for any decision affecting the student regarding honors, programs or activities available at or through the educational institution.

Other types of conduct which are prohibited in the District and which may constitute sexual harassment include:

1. Unwelcome sexual slurs, epithets, threats, verbal abuse, derogatory comments or sexually degrading descriptions;
2. Graphic verbal comments about an individual's body, or overly personal conversation;
3. Sexual jokes, stories, drawings, pictures or gestures;
4. Spreading sexual rumors;
5. Touching an individual's body or clothes in a sexual way;
6. Cornering or blocking of normal movements; or
7. Displaying sexually suggestive objects.
8. Electronic transmission of suggestive messages or materials.

B. REPORTING SEXUAL HARASSMENT

The District expects students to immediately report incidents of sexual harassment to the principal or designee or to another District administrator.

Any student who feels that he/she is being harassed should immediately contact the principal or site administrator in order to obtain a copy of the Complaint Procedures. Complaints of harassment can be filed in accordance with these procedures.

Complaint forms are available in the school office.

C. CONSEQUENCES

Any student who engages in the harassment (especially sexual harassment) of anyone in or from the District may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including expulsion.

STANDARDS OF CONDUCT FOR SCHOOL BUS TRANSPORTATION

The Southwest Transportation Agency is dedicated to providing pupil transportation services with maximum safety as our prime objective for all pupils. To ensure this level of safety, each student must behave in a satisfactory manner, allowing the driver to direct their undivided attention to driving.

BUS RULES

1. Cooperate with the driver. Follow directions the first time they are given.
2. Arrive at the bus stop not more than 5 minutes before the scheduled bus arrival. While going to and from the bus stop and while waiting for the bus, keep out of the street and off private property. Noise, rowdy behavior and property damage at the bus stop could cause the stop to be moved to a possibly more inconvenient location.

3. Board and leave the bus in an orderly manner. Do not push other students. Follow the driver's instructions concerning seating location and unloading procedure.
4. Be seated promptly. Be willing to share seat with fellow bus riders.
5. Always sit facing the front of the bus. Remain seated when the bus is in motion. Do not change seats without the permission of the driver. Do not "save" seats.
6. Keep hands off other people and their possessions.
7. Keep head, hands, and arms inside the bus at all times. Do not yell out of windows to others outside the bus.
8. Animals, insects, and reptiles are not permitted on the bus. Guide dogs and signal dogs are excepted. (54.2 Civil Code)
9. Large musical instruments, radios, playground equipment, etc., and other large, bulky items that cannot be carried on the student's lap are prohibited on the bus. (Special arrangements must be made to transport such items when required.) Personal items such as roller skates, skateboards, marbles, and balloons must be kept in backpacks. Special arrangements must be made for the transportation of athletic equipment. Cleats and or spikes must be removed before entering bus. Glass containers are **not permitted** on the bus at any time.
10. Bus aisle and emergency exits must be kept clear of books, lunches, musical instruments, etc.
11. Keep the bus clean. Students are not to eat, drink, or chew gum or tobacco on the bus. Exceptions must be cleared through the Agency.
12. Students must wear shoes and shirts at all times while on the bus. No open cosmetics or aerosol cans are permitted.
13. Do not use obscene or profane language. Smoking and lighting of matches are not permitted on the bus. No hazardous material (liquid, solid, or gas) may be permitted on the bus.
14. Students will be responsible for their individual behavior. It is not possible for a driver to watch all students at all times; therefore, saying "Somebody else was doing it too!" does not exempt a misbehaving student.
15. Do not deface or destroy bus equipment. Damage to seats, windows, and other parts of the bus is unnecessary and costly. Any damage will be paid for by the student responsible.
16. Avoid loud talking, loud laughter or unnecessary confusion. (It may divert the driver's attention and could result in an accident.)
17. Students living across the street upon which the bus is stopped to unload them should cross only when the driver indicates that it is safe to do so. Students must cross in front of the bus and walk straight across the street. Elementary and junior high students will be escorted across the street by the driver.
18. The luminescent indicators, lasers or other such devices are prohibited on the bus. These devices will be confiscated immediately and **not** returned.
19. All Students must be properly fastened in their seat when in a bus that is equipped with a restraint system.

STUDENT INFORMATION AND SERVICES

EXTRA/CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Extracurricular activities such as cheerleading, athletics, club membership and class activities are not part of the regular school curriculum and do not offer credit, unless part of a regular school day class session.

Co-curricular activities are those that will be associated with the curriculum in a regular classroom (drama, band, choral groups, yearbook, vocational programs, etc.).

Extracurricular activities and co-curricular activities beyond the requirements and expectations of the curriculum can enhance the educational and social development and experiences of students.

In order to maintain eligibility to participate in all activities, a student must:

1. Demonstrate satisfactory progress in meeting the requirements for graduation.
2. Maintain a minimum 2.0 or "C" grade point average on a 4.0 scale.
3. Receive no "F" grades at grade period or semester assessment.
4. Enroll and attend Expanded Learning Program or other required after school activities and abide by rules of the Expanded Learning Program (see page 10).

In addition, the following requirements must be met to participate in a class or club activity:

1. Students must possess a current Student ID card.
2. Student must participate in fund raising if applicable.

ASB CARDS/STUDENT I.D. CARDS

All students must be in possession of RHS picture I.D. card. By purchasing an Associated Student Body (ASB) card, a student becomes an active member of the student body. The ASB card entitles a student to the following privileges:

1. Right to represent Riverdale High School in athletic events and as spirit leaders.
2. Right to be a member of any recognized RHS club or organization.
3. Free admission to home regular season athletic events.
4. Reduced admission to all away league athletic events.
5. Reduced admission to ASB dances.
6. Right to attend honor roll trip if student meets academic qualifications.
7. Right to participate in extracurricular activities with his/her class or club as long as fund raising requirements are fulfilled.
8. Are required to check-out books or technology from the library.

Students may purchase an ASB card for \$20.00 at student orientation. After student orientation, the cost of an ASB card will be \$25.00. ASB cards can be purchased from the office of the Activities Director.

A family plan will be available for any family that has 3 or more children attending Riverdale High School. With two (2) paid ASB cards, the third is free. Each ASB card after the third will be ½ price.

For a fee of \$5.00, a student may have their lost Student Body Card replaced. Students will not be allowed to enter games, dances, or other school activities at a reduced rate without their card.

Students not in possession of an I.D. card will be at the end of the lunch line until those students with I.D. cards are served.

STUDENT EXPENSES

Students are expected to supply their own paper, pencils and pens.

1. At the end of each grading period, students who have any outstanding bills/fees will be placed on the Non-privileged list until the bills/fees have been cleared by the office.
2. No student will be allowed to participate in any graduation activity or ceremony until all outstanding bills/fees have been cleared by the office.

Students are responsible for all school property in their possession and will be required to pay for loss or damage to such property.

STUDENT INSURANCE

The school does not carry health insurance to cover injuries to students. However, parents may purchase health insurance through the school to provide limited medical reimbursements and coverage.

As mandated by law, before a student can participate in an athletic contest and/or in a music program, he/she must show evidence of medical insurance.

STUDENT LUNCH CARDS

At the time of registration, the student receives a Riverdale High School student I.D. card which has their individual barcode.

CAFETERIA

Breakfast before school and a breakfast meal served at brunch will be provided free to all students. Students will be limited to one free breakfast per day. Snacks are available to all students at a modest cost during brunch and lunch periods at the Outpost. Students are expected to maintain appropriate cafeteria behavior. No student will be allowed in the kitchen.

CLOSED CAMPUS

Riverdale High School maintains a closed campus. Students may not leave campus during the school day, including during the lunch period. After school, campus will be closed to students not in the direct supervision of an adult who is assigned to an athletic team or after school program component. Students are not to leave campus and return to campus during the afterschool program.

HALL PASSES

There will be one standard hall pass which will be used by teachers to send students to the office or restroom. This same hall pass will be used by the office to send for students. Students are not to be out of class without a hall pass.

PERSONAL TELEPHONE CALLS

Students are not to use the phone in the main office at anytime, **unless permission is given by the office personnel.**

WORK PERMITS

Work permits are issued in the main office for students who have a part-time or summer job outside of school hours. Students must be eligible, have good attendance, and be in good standing in order to receive a work permit.

OFF-CAMPUS PERMITS

Off-campus permits are issued in the main office. Permits will be issued only by consent of parents or guardians of the student. Permits issued will be **verified by the main office prior to departure.** No student should leave campus for any reason without clearing their departure through the main office.

Procedure:

1. Off-campus permits will be issued for the following reasons:

- a. Illness, verified by school personnel. At no time is a student to leave school and go home ill without first being cleared through the main office.
- b. Appointment with a doctor or dentist. The stamp of the doctor or dentist must be obtained and presented at the main office when returning to school.
- c. Illness and/or death in the family or funeral attendance when verified by parent or guardian.
- d. Off-campus permits may be issued for reasons other than medical purposes if special permission is granted from the main office and only with the consent of parent or guardian.

STUDENTS WILL NOT BE RELEASED TO ANY PARTY NOT LISTED ON THE CONTACT LIST.

STUDENT VEHICLES

The student parking lot is located on the south side of the south gym. All student vehicles must be parked in this area.

Students are **not** to be in the parking lot unless they are arriving at or leaving school. If a student needs to go to his/her car, he/she must obtain prior approval from the administration and/or be escorted to and from his/her car by school officials.

*Students parking within the student parking lot must display a school issued parking pass on their rear view mirror at all times.

All students' cars that are not in the designated student parking area or are occupying more than one parking space will be subject to towing and impoundment at the owner's expense.

STUDENT PARKING

Students issued a school parking permit must adhere to the following rules and regulations:

1. The "Hanger Permit" must be attached to the rear view mirror so it is clearly visible from outside of the vehicle.
2. Each vehicle parked in the parking lot must have a separate registration and permit.
3. Students are to park in the student parking lot, the south side of the South Gym only and must be parked in the stalls correctly.
4. Students are not to sit in parked cars or loiter in the parking lot anytime during the school day.
5. Students will not be allowed access to their vehicle during the day or place in or remove items unless they obtain prior approval from the administration and/or escorted to and from his/her vehicle by school officials.
6. Drivers are to adhere to vehicle code laws and specific rules of the RHS campus.
7. A 5 mile per hour speed limit must be observed in all parking areas.
8. Penalties or misuse of cars include: loss of school parking privilege, loss of citizenship points, and/or possible towing and impoundment at the owner's expense.
9. Parking permits are issued to students that have completed and submitted applications to the Coordinator of School Safety. All lost permits are subject to a \$5 replacement fee.

LIBRARY BOOKS

1. Library books will be issued by the library personnel. Students are responsible for the care of each book they checked out. Students and parents will be held liable for full payment if books are stolen, lost, or show excessive wear or damage.
2. A fine will be charged for all books that are overdue. The fine will be \$.05 per day with a maximum fine of \$3.00.
3. At the end of each grading period, students who have overdue library books will be placed on the nonprivilege list until they pay their fine, return their books, or pay for the book.
4. When a student checks out of school, he/she must return all library books to the library.

TEXTBOOKS

1. Textbooks will be issued by the library personnel. Students are responsible for the care of each text assigned to them. Students and parents will be held liable for full payment if books are stolen, lost, or show excessive wear or damage. Teachers will check periodically on the condition of the texts. Students **must check in the same text that was issued to them.** Students have an obligation for lost or damaged books or materials. Books must be paid for at the end of each school year.
2. Book covers will be issued with the textbooks (if available).
3. When textbook use is completed, students must return their books to the library in an organized manner.
4. When a student checks out of school, he/she must return the textbooks to the library, not the classroom teacher.
5. When students write unnecessarily in textbooks, they ruin those books for future use. Students will be charged for the book(s) in this case just as if they had lost them.

LAPTOPS

1. Laptops will be issued by technology personnel. Students are responsible for the care of the laptop assigned to them. Students and parents will be held liable for full payment if laptop is stolen, lost, or shows excessive wear or damage. (Please note that students and parents have the opportunity to purchase insurance coverage for laptops through RJUSD when they are checked out to assist in the cost associated with loss, theft, and/or damage) Students must return the same laptop that was issued to them. Students have an obligation for lost or damaged laptops. Laptops must be paid for at the end of the school year, if they are not returned in adequate condition.
2. When laptop use is completed, students must return their device (laptop and power cord) to the technology department in an organized manner with all stickers and decals removed.
3. When a student checks out of school, he/she must return the laptop and charger to the technology department.

STUDENT GOVERNMENT

The government of the Riverdale High School Student Body is vested in a student council. The Executive Council meets periodically. The General Student Council consists of student body officers, commissioners, class officers, and club presidents. The General Council meets at least once a month at which time business is transacted and student body activities are discussed.

Associated Student Body, class and club officers serve one year and are elected in the spring preceding their term of office. Commissioners are selected during the first general session. A student must meet all of the academic eligibility requirements to hold an ASB position as listed below.

Students running for ASB office and class office will do so using the popular vote method of election. Students will vote for the candidates to serve in specified positions. If a student has a plurality of votes, but no majority, there will be a run-off between the top two candidates for that position.

In the event there is no candidate who declared for a certain office, the runner-up of the immediately higher office will be appointed. If that candidate declines the position, the remaining newly-elected officers will determine if that office can remain vacant, and will consequently absorb those duties.

Students running for club office will be elected using the method that is outlined in that club's by-laws.

ASB OFFICE REQUIREMENTS

1. Student must have a minimum 3.25 cumulative GPA and be academically eligible at the time of elections, and maintain eligibility during his/her time in office, and maintain acceptable citizenship per the RHS Student Handbook.
2. Student must be willing and able to work during non-school hours by request of the Activities Director and/or the class advisor. This can include summer, lunch, and before-and after-school duties
3. Student ideally have previously held a class or club office and/or been enrolled in or have completed a Leadership class if it can be fit into their class schedules.
4. Student must be involved in extracurricular activities.
5. Student must be willing to be enrolled in a Leadership class.
6. Student must be willing to post campaign material around campus.
7. Student must be willing to give a campaign speech to classmates at a time pre-designated by the Activities Director.

CLASS OFFICE REQUIREMENTS

1. Student must have a minimum 3.25 cumulative GPA, be academically eligible at the time of elections, and maintain eligibility during his/her time in office and maintain acceptable citizenship per the RHS Student Handbook.
2. Student must be willing and able to work during non-school hours by request of the Activities Director and/or the class advisor. This can include summer, lunch and before-and after-school duties.
3. Student must be involved in extracurricular activities.
4. Student must be willing to be enrolled in a Leadership class if it can be fit into their class schedule.
5. Student must be willing to post campaign material around campus.
6. Student must be willing to give a campaign speech to classmates at a time pre-designated by the Activities Director.
7. Students must have attended 75% of class meetings during the previous Academic Year in order to run for class office.

8. Students must have attended at least 90% of all General Assembly and Executive Board meetings in order to run for class office.
9. Students must have participated in at least 80% of events during the previous Academic Year and 90% of events during the current amount of Academic Year in order to remain in compliance with Class Officer Expectations.

CLUB OFFICE, LINK CREW, AND LEADERSHIP REQUIREMENTS

1. Student must have a minimum 3.25 cumulative GPA and be academically eligible at the time of elections, and maintain eligibility during his/her time in office.
2. Student must be willing and able to work during non-school hours by request of the club advisor and/or the Activities Director.
3. Student must be involved in the extracurricular activities of the organization.

STUDENT BODY ORGANIZATIONS

Block R: The objectives of this club are to bring those students lettering in a sport closer together to produce appreciation and understanding for all sports and to promote pride in being a member of the athletic program. Any student who has lettered in one varsity sport is eligible to become a member.
(Mrs. Sunamoto - asunamoto@rjUSD.org)

AVID: Students enrolled in the AVID program have the goal of attending a college within the University of California system, and place a particular emphasis on their preparation to be "college ready" students. Students in the AVID club fundraise for many college visits as well as other activities which focus on their goal. **(Ms. Pena – jreyes@rjUSD.org)**

Baseball Club: The Baseball Club's mission it to make baseball a positive, rewarding and educational experience that will contribute to the player's role as a student and to learn experiences as a club member that will help them succeed in today's society academically and athletically. Any athlete who makes the JV or Varsity baseball team is eligible to participate as a member in the Baseball Club.
(Mr. Cantieri – jonathancantieri@rjUSD.org)

Basketball Club: The Basketball Club's mission it to make basketball a positive, rewarding and educational experience that will contribute to the player's role as a student and to learn experiences as a club member that will help them succeed in today's society academically and athletically.
(Mr. Banuelos -mbanuelos@rjUSD.org)

California Scholarship Federation (CSF): CSF exists to foster high standards of scholarship and general achievement in Riverdale High School. It is a statewide organization whose merit is recognized by colleges and universities. Activities include annual trips to various colleges throughout California. To become a member, students must meet minimum GPA requirements as set forth by the CSF.
(Mr. Weibert– mweibert@rjUSD.org)

Cancer Awareness Club: The goal of the club is to raise awareness of this disease through various events to create an element of kindness and compassion within one's self, family and community.
(Mrs. Aguiniga-Leon – iaquiniga@rjUSD.org)

Chorus Club: To encourage and promote friendship among the entire student body. Preserve the common welfare and general interest of the community and unity among all groups.
(TBA)

Cross Country Club – The Cross Country Club's mission is to make playing sports for Riverdale High School a positive, rewarding, and educational experience that will contribute to the athlete's role as a student and to learn from their experiences as a club member that will help them succeed after graduation.

Softball Club: The mission is to make playing softball for Riverdale High School a positive, rewarding, and educational experience that will contribute to the players' role as a student and to learn from their experiences as a club member that will help them succeed after graduation.

(Mr. Close – bclose@rjUSD.org)

Drama Club: The Drama Club offers students the opportunity to learn more about public speaking and theater arts and to meet other students with similar interests. Students must be enrolled in a drama class to be eligible to participate in this organization or have a background and/or interest in theater arts or recommended by the drama class teacher. **(Ms. Jessup – cassidyjessup@rjUSD.org)**

Eclub: The eClub aims to provide a conduit by which students can access entrepreneurial resources, network with community entrepreneurs, and share ideas. The club is dedicated to furthering understanding about new and small businesses. It is run in conjunction with the Small Business Management course and the RHS School Store aka "The Supply Closet." **(Mr. Joe – ejoe@rjUSD.org)**

Football Club - The Football Club's mission is to make playing football for Riverdale High School a positive, rewarding, and educational experience that will contribute to the players' role as a student and to learn from their experiences as a club member that will help them succeed after graduation. **(Mr. Close - bclose@rjUSD.org)**

Future Farmers of America (FFA): The FFA is comprised of students who have an interest in agriculture. Students must be enrolled in an agriculture class to be eligible to participate in this national organization. Activities include showing livestock at local fairs, public speaking contests, judging contests and leadership conferences. **(Ms. Garibaldi – morgangaribaldi@rjUSD.org)**

Gay/Straight Alliance (GSA): The mission of the GSA is to promote understanding and acceptance of the LGBT community, and all others, as it is understood that we live in a world with tremendous diversity amongst its people. **(Mrs. Nemeth – pnemeth@rjUSD.org)**

Soccer Club: Their mission is to engage participants in the rewarding, motivated yet exciting sport while maintaining the positive learning education experience. Every soccer player who participates will contribute to the fun, motivation, and support of teammates providing essential elements of team work. **(Mrs. Sunamoto – ashleysunamoto@rjUSD.org)**

Golf Club: The Golf Club's mission is to appreciate, respect, and enjoy the lifetime sport of golf. The club will also promote proper course/life etiquette, management skills, friendships, and respect for other members of the club. **(Mr. Banuelos – mbanuelos@rjUSD.org)**

Leo Club: The RHS Leo Club provides the students of the Riverdale High School community with an opportunity for the development and contribution, individually and collectively, to serve as responsible members of their local, national, and international communities. **(Mr. Reina– rreina@rjUSD.org)**

Pep & Cheer Club: The objective of the Pep Club is to promote school spirit, support the athletes through rallies and cheers and to aide the cheerleaders at rallies and games. Members must be students who are interested in school activities which promote school spirit in all areas of school life. **(Ms. Garrett – mysteregarrett@rjUSD.org)**

Softball Club: The mission is to make playing softball for Riverdale High School a positive, rewarding, and educational experience that will contribute to the players' role as a student and to learn from their experiences as a club member that will help them succeed after graduation. **(Mr. Close – bclose@rjUSD.org)**

Tennis Club: The Tennis Club's mission is to appreciate and comprehend the sport of tennis as well as promote friendship and respect among its members. Anyone playing on the men's or women's tennis team is eligible to join.

Track Club - The Track Club's mission is to make playing sports for Riverdale High School a positive, rewarding, and educational experience that will contribute to the players' role as a student and to learn from their experiences as a club member that will help them succeed after graduation

Volleyball Club: The Volleyball Club's mission it to make volleyball a positive, rewarding and educational experience that will contribute to the player's role as a student and to learn experiences as a club member that will help them succeed after graduation.

Student Body Officers/Advisors 2026-27

ASB President
ASB Vice-President
ASB Secretary
ASB Treasurer
ASB Reporter
Activities Director, Advisor

Xailah Camacho
Aliyah Ignacio Martinez
Ahtziry Birrute-Gomez
Angel Ramirez-Suarez
Marianayelly Torres
Mr. Mullane

Class Officers/Advisors 2026-27

Class of 2027

Senior Class President
Senior Class Vice President
Senior Class Secretary
Senior Class Treasurer
Senior Class Reporter
Senior Class Advisors

Victoria Pena
Kathleen Warden
Mamie Cox
Carissa Lopez
Diana Moreno
Ms. Marcella Caballos and Ms. Jessica Reyes

Class of 2028

Junior Class President
Junior Class Vice President
Junior Class Secretary
Junior Class Treasurer
Junior Class Reporter
Junior Class Advisors

Marissa Jiminez
Julian Murillo Cortes
Vacant
Blake Church
Belen Vargas Vera
Mr. Eric Mullane and Mr. Tim Warden

Class of 2029

Sophomore Class President
Sophomore Class Vice President
Sophomore Class Secretary
Sophomore Class Treasurer
Sophomore Class Reporter
Sophomore Class Advisors

Griselda Gallegos
Veronica Sanzon
Eleny Martinez
Alexandra Cordova
Vacant
Ms. Megan Edlund and Ms. Cassidy Jessup

Class of 2030

Freshman Cabinet to be determined Fall 2026
Freshman Class Advisors

Elections in the Fall, TBA
TBA

School Colors: Green and White
School Mascot: Cowboys
GO COWBOYS!

Truancy or Excessive Absences

Guidelines

First Notification of Truancy or Excessive Absences

On the 4th day of unjustified absences, the “First Notification of Truancy or Excessive Absences” (letter 1) is to be mailed.

Second Notification of Truancy or excessive Absences

On the 5th day of unjustified absences, the “Second Notification of Truancy or Excessive Absences” (letter 2) is to be mailed. An appointment is to be made to meet with the School Attendance review Team (SART), which will consist of the Principal, Assistant Principal and local law enforcement (Deputy), when possible, is to be scheduled.

Third Notification of Continued Truancy

On the 6th day of unjustified absences, the “Third Notification of Continued Truancy” (letter 3) is to be mailed. A second meeting with the School Principal and local law enforcement (Deputy), when possible, is to be scheduled.

Notification Letter of SARB Referral

On the 7th day of unjustified absences, the “Notification Letter of SARB Referral” (letter 4) is to be mailed. The Principal is to notify the family that this matter has been referred to the School Attendance Review Board and that a hearing will be held.

Fourth Notification of Truancy

The “Fourth Notification of Truancy (letter 5) will be sent by the District notifying the family that they are required to attend a scheduled SARB hearing. If the parents/guardians do not assume responsibility for their child’s truancy at this point, the District will proceed with other legal referrals.



RIVERDALE HIGH SCHOOL

"Home of the Cowboys"

2026-2027



August 10-12

August 13

September 7

October 12

November 11

November 23-27

November 26

December 21-January 8

December 25

January 1

Staff Orientation

School Begins

Labor Day

Non-School Day

Veteran's Day

Thanksgiving Break

Thanksgiving

Winter Break

Christmas Day

New Year's Day

January 11

January 18

February 8

February 15

March 22 - March 29

April 26

May 31

June 10

June 19

July 4

Non-Student Day

Martin Luther King, Jr. Day

Lincoln's Birthday Observed

President's Day

Spring Break

Non-School Day

Memorial Day

School Ends

Juneteenth

Independence Day

AUGUST

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
						1
2	3	4	5	6	7	8
9	10	11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20	21	22
23	24	25	26	27	28	29
30	31					

SEPTEMBER

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
		1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
27	28	29	30			

OCTOBER

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
				1	2	3
4	5	6	7	8	9	10
11	12	13	14	15	16	17
18	19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30	31

NOVEMBER

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30					

DECEMBER

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
		1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	m16	m17	m18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
27	28	29	30	31		

JANUARY

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
					1	2
3	4	5	6	7	8	9
10	11	12	13	14	15	16
17	18	19	20	21	22	23
24	25	26	27	28	29	30
31						

FEBRUARY

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
	1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12	13
14	15	16	17	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	25	26	27
28						

MARCH

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
	1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12	13
14	15	16	17	18	m19	20
21	22	23	24	25	26	27
28	29	30	31			

APRIL

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
				1	2	3
4	5	6	7	8	9	10
11	12	13	14	15	16	17
18	19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30	

MAY

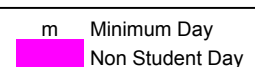
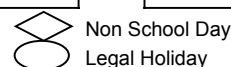
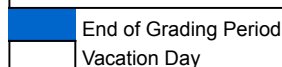
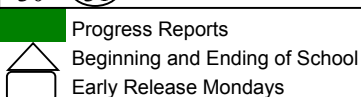
S	M	T	W	T	F	S
						1
2	3	4	5	6	7	8
9	10	11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20	21	22
23	24	25	26	27	28	29
30	31					

JUNE

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
		1	2	3	4	5
6	7	m8	m9	m10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
27	28	29	30			

JULY

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
				1	2	3
4	5	6	7	8	9	10
11	12	13	14	15	16	17
18	19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30	31



Riverdale High School/Horizon High School

Regular Day Schedule

8:06		
<u>Period</u>	<u>Class Time</u>	<u>Minutes</u>
1	8:10 – 9:02	52
2	9:06 – 9:56	50
Brunch	9:56 – 10:11	15
3	10:15 – 11:05	50
4	11:09 – 11:59	50
Lunch	11:59 – 12:33	34
5	12:37 – 1:27	50
6	1:31 – 2:21	50
7	2:25 – 3:15	50

Passing Time Four (4) Minutes

Early Release Day Schedule

8:06		
<u>Period</u>	<u>Class Time</u>	<u>Minutes</u>
1	8:10 – 8:56	46
2	9:00 – 9:41	41
3	9:45 – 10:26	41
4	10:30 – 11:11	41
Lunch	11:11 – 11:45	34
5	11:49 – 12:30	41
6	12:34 – 1:15	41
7	1:19 – 2:00	41

Passing Time Four (4) Minutes

Activity Day Schedule

8:06		
<u>Period</u>	<u>Class Time</u>	<u>Minutes</u>
1	8:10 – 8:56	46
2	9:00 – 9:44	44
Brunch	9:44 – 9:59	15
3	10:03 – 10:47	44
4	10:51 – 11:35	44
5	11:39 – 12:23	44
Lunch	12:23 – 12:57	34
6	1:01 – 1:45	44
7	1:49 – 2:33	44
8	2:37 – 3:15	38

Passing Time Four (4) Minutes



Wed/Thurs Block Schedule

8:06		
<u>Period</u>	<u>Class Time</u>	<u>Minutes</u>
1/2	8:10 – 9:57	107
Brunch	9:57 – 10:12	15
3/4	10:16 – 11:59	103
Lunch	11:59 – 12:33	34
5/6	12:37 – 2:20	103
7	2:24 – 3:15	51
Wednesday = 1, 3, 5 and 7 periods		
Thursday = 2, 4, 6, and 7 periods		

Passing Time Four (4) Minutes

Minimum Day Schedule

8:06		
<u>Period</u>	<u>Class Time</u>	<u>Minutes</u>
1	8:10 – 8:46	36
2	8:50 – 9:23	33
3	9:27 – 10:00	33
4	10:04 – 10:37	33
Brunch/Lunch	10:37 – 11:10	33
5	11:14 – 11:47	33
6	11:51 – 12:24	33
7	12:28 – 1:01	33

Passing Time Four (4) Minutes

Foggy/Late Arrival Day Schedule

9:56			
<u>Period</u>	<u>Class Time</u>	<u>Minutes</u>	
1	10:00 – 10:44	44	
2	10:48 – 11:28	40	
3	11:32 – 12:12	40	
Lunch	12:12 – 12:49	37	
4	12:53 – 1:33	40	
5	1:37 – 2:17	40	
6	2:21 – 3:01	40	
7	3:05 – 3:45	40	

Passing Time Four (4) Minutes

Foggy Day Block Schedule

9:56			
<u>Period</u>	<u>Class Time</u>	<u>Minutes</u>	
1 st /2 nd	10:00 – 11:27	87	
7	11:31 – 12:11	40	
Lunch	12:11 – 12:45	34	
3 rd /4 th	12:49 – 2:12	83	
5 th /6 th	2:22 – 3:45	83	

Passing Time Four (4) Minutes



RIVERDALE UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

FOGGY DAY SCHEDULE

2026-2027

We will be following the procedures outlined below for the 2026-2027 school year.

Please keep this notice for reference.

*** Parents and students may be informed of foggy day schedules by going directly to the **Southwest Transportation Agency** website, www.southwesttpa.org. Notification of a foggy day schedule is also posted on **Channel 18**. It will broadcast schools with foggy day schedules from 5:45 a.m. to 12 noon. **Radio stations 580 and 107.5** will also broadcast foggy day schedules. It will be announced we are on Plan A, Plan B, or Plan C. Fipps Primary, Riverdale Elementary, Riverdale High and Horizon High Schools operate their buses as 1 unit. If a "Foggy Day Schedule" is called for one school, it will apply to all schools in the District.

PLAN A

1. Classes start at 10:00 a.m.
2. Buses run about 1 hour 45 minutes later than the regular day schedule.
3. Students are to be at school between 9:30 a.m. and 10:00 a.m.
 - * Absences or tardiness due to unsafe weather or fog conditions (when a parent/guardian is unable to transport their student safely) are excused upon parent/guardian notification to the school.
4. Classes are dismissed for the day at Fipps Primary School at 3:15 p.m., 3:30 p.m. at Riverdale Elementary School, and 3:45 p.m. at Riverdale High School.
5. Foggy Days will be called on a daily basis, unless you are informed otherwise.

PLAN B

1. Buses run about 2 hours and 45 minutes later than the regular day schedule.
 - a. Occasionally, fog conditions persist and a decision is made to delay bus service for 2 hours and 45 minutes.
 - b. Channel 18 is notified and broadcasts the update, "Plan B". Classes start at 10:00 a.m.

***NOTE:** Berylwood stops will be at 9:45 a.m. on Plan A or B

PLAN C

1. Morning buses are canceled. Afternoon buses will transport students. Classes start at 10:00 a.m.

PROCEDURES FOR CALLING A FOGGY DAY SCHEDULE

The following procedures have been reviewed for determining if a foggy day schedule should be called:

1. Individuals living in the District are contacted to determine if a foggy situation exists in their respective areas.
2. If one of the contacts reports fog conditions relative to guidelines, a foggy day schedule will be implemented for the day.

NOTE: *Each contact is asked to determine the fog conditions by clearly sighting an object (a light) 200 feet away.

***If a Foggy Day is called on an Early Release Monday, we will follow a regular Foggy Day Schedule.**



Riverdale High School
2026-27

